

lower means
more similar

average of 2 KL
divergences

$$JSD(P||Q) = \frac{1}{2} D_{KL}(P||M) + \frac{1}{2} D_{KL}(Q||M)$$

Probability

measures

measures

Distributions

how different

how different

(that we are

P from M.

Q from M.

comparing)

KL formula

$$D_{KL}(P||Q) = \sum_x P(x) \cdot \log \left(\frac{P(x)}{Q(x)} \right)$$

- $D_{KL}(P||Q) \neq D_{KL}(Q||P)$ how different Q from P.
- O/p is not distance - it tells you how different two distributions are
- P & Q are same, KL divergence = 0

KL

Given

$$P = [0.9, 0.1] \rightarrow \text{real}$$

$$Q = [0.5, 0.5] \rightarrow \text{predicted}$$

$$D_{KL}(P||Q) = 0.9 \log_2 \left(\frac{0.9}{0.5} \right) + 0.1 \log_2 \left(\frac{0.1}{0.5} \right)$$

$$= 0.9(0.847) + 0.1(-2.322)$$

$$= 0.762 - 0.232$$

$$= 0.53 \text{ bits}$$

Q is not great match for P .

JSD

Given

$$P = [0.5, 0.3, 0.2] \rightarrow \text{Real}$$

$$Q = [0.2, 0.2, 0.6] \rightarrow \text{Predicted / generated}$$

Step 1:

find avg distribution M

$$M = \frac{1}{2} (P + Q)$$

$$= \frac{1}{2} \left[\frac{0.5+0.2}{2}, \frac{0.3+0.2}{2}, \frac{0.2+0.6}{2} \right]$$

$$= [0.35, 0.25, 0.4]$$

Step 2:compute KL $D_{KL}(P||M)$

$$D_{KL}(P||M) = \sum P(x) \cdot \ln \left(\frac{P(x)}{M(x)} \right)$$

$$\begin{aligned} 1) & 0.5 \cdot \ln(0.5/0.35) = 0.178 \\ 2) & 0.3 \cdot \ln(0.3/0.25) = 0.0546 \\ 3) & 0.2 \cdot \ln(0.2/0.4) = -0.1386 \end{aligned}$$

$$D_{KL}(P||M) = 0.094$$

Step 3:

compute $D_{KL}(Q||m)$

- 1) $0.2 \times \ln(0.2/0.35) = -0.112$
- 2) $0.2 \times \ln(0.2/0.25) = -0.0446$
- 3) $0.6 \times \ln(0.6/0.4) = 0.243$

$$D_{KL}(Q||m) = 0.0864$$

Step 4 :

$$= \frac{1}{2} (0.094 + 0.0864)$$

$$= 0.0902$$

$$JSD \approx 0.0902$$

— distributions are somewhat different but not totally opposite

— JSD stays betⁿ 0 to 1 so this is a low-to-moderate difference.